The National Archives' reference FO 17/686

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British Consulate for Taiwan,
Taiwanfoo, 12th May 1874

No. 9.

My Lord,

I have the honour to enclose copy of my Despatch to Her Majesty's Minister at Peking, No 6, of the 11th-12th Instant, concerning the arrival of a Japanese expedition in Formosa.

I have the honour to be,
My Lord,
Your Lordship's
most obedient
humble Servant,

Consul Officiating.

The Right Honourable
Lord Tenterden,
&c. &c. &c.
Foreign Office,
London.

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12th May 1874
Mr. W. Gregory
No. 9.
One Inclosure
Recd. 21 July
Arrival of Japanese
expedition in Formosa.

✓ The Queen
✓ Mr Disraeli
✓ Circulate

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British Consulate for Taiwan,

Takow, 11 May 1874.

Copy

No. 6.

Sir,

The Japanese expedition to Formosa, of which you will have heard, has arrived (at least in part) and commenced establishing itself on shore at ※Liang-kiaou or Long-kiaou ※ Bay, which is on the Western ※ side of Formosa, about ten miles from the South end of the island.

※ 琅嶠

The

T. F. Wade Esq C.B.

H. B. M. Envoy Extraordinary,

&c, &c &c,

Peking.

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The transport "Nepaul" was the first to arrive. She had been at Amoy. She was seen in passing, from the Takow signal station, on the afternoon of the 6th Instant; and we learnt what She was by the arrival of a — merchant steamer from Amoy.

In the evening of the 7th, — H. M. S. "Hornet", Commander O. S. Cameron, arrived from Amoy. Commander Cameron had received instructions from Vice Admiral, Sir Charles Shadwell. On the 8th the "Hornet" with myself on board proceeded down the coast, and anchored in Liang-kiaou Bay in the evening. It is a good anchorage in a North East wind, but probably bad in westerly winds. We found the "Nepaul" at anchor there.

Next morning (the 9th) we went ashore, and visited the camp — which the Japanese were — establishing; they had some artillery ashore, and about seven tents were erected. We ~~saw~~ met three Europeans or — Americans at the camp.

We visited two of the — neighbouring Chinese villages. The principal one is a roughly-walled place, locally called Ch'a

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Ch'a-sia 柴城 (Ch'ai-ch'ing). We were very well received. The people did not seem alarmed at the arrival of the Japanese. At one very nice respectable house and trading-place where we called, we learnt that they regarded the Japanese expedition favourably, as being against their enemies the Mow-tan 牡丹 or Baw-tan savages; they understood it to be on account of the slaughter of Lew-chew people who were coming with tribute or offerings to China, and expected that the Chinese authorities would come down and

and co-operate with the Japanese.

As regards their trade, they export (to Taiwanfoo and the Pescadores or elsewhere), firewood, timber or ornamental woods, wheat, pulse, and some rice; &c.

I have just referred to Mr Warren's report of his visit to the same neighbourhood in the "Loudoun Castle" shipwreck case in 1871, (enclosed to the Legation in Mr Hewlett's Despatch No. 16 of 30 September 1871). Perhaps Liang-kiaow is a general name, and the particular place at where we anchored may have been

Mr

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Mr Warren's Sia-liaou.

We delayed departure till the next morning, as the arrival of the rest of the expedition was hourly expected. After leaving on the morning of the 10th, a few miles up the coast, we met a Japanese transport going towards Liang-kiaou, carrying what was understood to be an Admiral's flag. Far away to the South was visible the smoke of another steamer, which (if from Japan) would very probably have come round the South end of Formosa, and might perhaps have made

Some

Some landing at the South End or on the East coast.

Your obedient Servant,

(Signed) Wm Gregory
Consul officiating

P. S. Taiwanfoo, 12th May. – I came hither yesterday (coming in H.M.S. "Hornet" from Takow to Anping); and today Commander Cameron and I called upon the Taoutai. He was without instructions or advices from his superiors about the Japanese expedition.

There has been some degree of excitement and alarm among the Chinese at the ports, but they seem tranquil now. The regular literary examinations are going on here.

(Signed) Wm Gregory

True Copy
Wm Gregory

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British Consulate for Taiwan,
Takow, 31 May 1874.

No. 10.

My Lord,

In continuation of my despatch No. 9 of the 12th Instant, I have the honour to enclose copies of the undermentioned papers, relating to the Japanese expedition to

The Right Honourable
Lord Tenterden,
&c &c &c
Foreign Office,
London,

Rr Gregory
to
Rr Lowder
11-12 May 1874.
Arrival of Japanese
expedition in Formosa

Enclosure

in Mr Gregory's No. 9

of May 12th 1874

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